

Invoice Automation — How It Works

Proof-of-concept overview for stakeholder review

What Problem Does This Solve?

Accounts payable teams spend time opening emails, downloading invoice PDFs, and manually typing vendor names, amounts, and line items into systems. This tool automates the reading step and puts every invoice in one review queue before it is saved.

How Invoices Enter the System

Path 1 — Email (Automatic)

The system connects to a dedicated Gmail inbox. When a vendor sends an invoice PDF, the system detects it within about two minutes, reads the document, and adds it to a Pending Review list. No one has to download the attachment manually.

Path 2 — Manual Upload

A team member can upload a PDF directly from the Process Invoice screen — useful for invoices received by other channels (WhatsApp, courier, shared drive, etc.).

What Happens After an Invoice Arrives

1. Read the document — The system extracts text from the PDF (including scanned documents where possible).
2. Understand the invoice — AI identifies vendor, invoice number, dates, amounts, and line items.
3. Queue for review — The invoice appears in Pending Review. Nothing is saved to the official record until a person approves it.
4. Human review — A finance or operations user checks the extracted data, fixes any errors, and confirms totals.
5. Approve and save — Once approved, the invoice is stored in the system and appears under Saved Invoices.

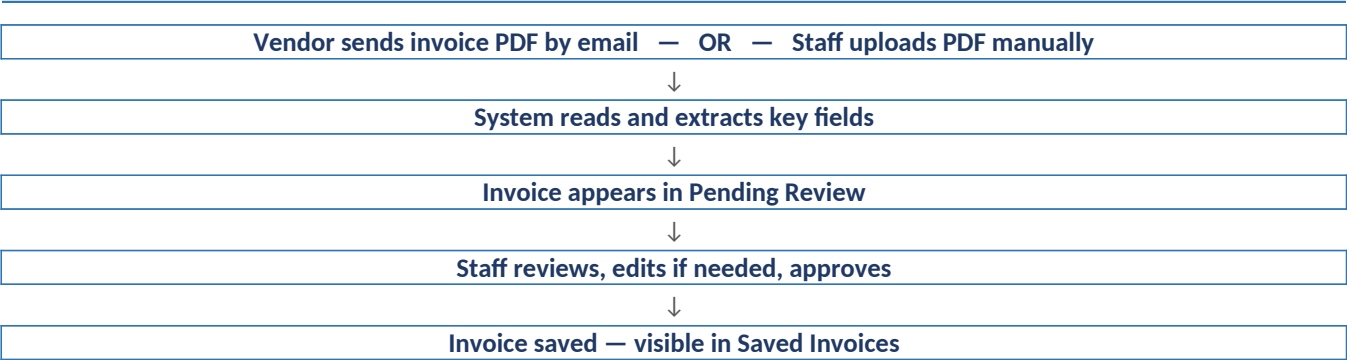
Why Human Review Matters

AI extraction is fast but not perfect. The review step ensures accuracy before anything enters your books — the right balance of automation and control for finance teams.

Three Screens Your Team Uses

Screen	Purpose
Process Invoice	Upload a PDF manually or pull one from Gmail
Pending Review	Inbox of invoices waiting for approval (especially from email)
Saved Invoices	Approved invoices already in the system

End-to-End Flow



Business Benefits

- **Less manual data entry** — vendor and amount fields are pre-filled.
- **Faster processing** — email invoices are detected automatically.
- **Control retained** — nothing is finalized without human approval.
- **Single place to work** — one queue instead of scattered emails and folders.

Current Status

This is a working proof of concept suitable for demonstration. It is not yet production-ready for enterprise deployment — security hardening, multi-user access, and full audit controls would come in a later phase.

What You Need to Run the Demo

- Gmail inbox with invoice PDFs (or sample PDF files for manual upload)
- OpenAI API for document understanding
- One person to walk through Pending Review → Approve → Saved Invoices

Bottom Line

The repo is clean enough for a C-level demo: small codebase, clear architecture, no dummy systems, no legacy OAuth stack. Optional housekeeping (delete migration script, refresh readme, trim unused helpers) is minor and can wait until after the demo.